BUILDING A SOUND QUALITY-OF-CARE AND PATIENT SAFETY CULTURE

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NATIONAL AUTHORITY FOR QUALITY MANAGEMENT IN HEALTHCARE

NATIONAL CONTEXT

- The Romanian public institution responsible for quality of care and patient safety is **NATIONAL AUTHORITY FOR QUALITY MANAGEMENT IN HEALTHCARE (ISQua accredited), created** in 2016, having as the main goal the continuous improvement of **the quality of care and patient safety**
- In the process of building a quality-of-care culture NAQMH's main tool is **the accreditation process of the healthcare providers** (hospitals, primary and ambulatory care).
  - ✓ The NAQMH has reached a full-scale deployment of quality management standards in hospitals and evaluated hospitals(private and public owned) compliance with standards for the second time since the implementation of the accreditation.
  - ✓ The NAQMH elaborated the quality standards for the third cycle of accreditation
  - Monitoring quality and ensure the accreditation of the health providers in primary care and ambulatory care will start in 2027

MAIN STEPS IN BUILDING QUALITY-OF-CARE CULTURE

1. The set-up of the NAQMH-2016
2. The elaboration and implementation of the quality management standards for hospitals
3. The elaboration of the quality management standards in primary and ambulatory care
4. The elaboration of the manual and guides for quality management standards in primary and ambulatory care
5. Quality of care initiatives financed through NRRP

NRRP's QUALITY-OF-CARE ACTIONS

- Elaborating a set of 25 quality indicators and piloting them
- Capacity building actions
- Actions for promoting quality-of-care culture in hospitals
- Elaborating the National Strategy for Quality of Care and Patient Safety

B. RAISING AWARENESS OF QUALITY-OF-CARE CULTURE AND CAPACITY BUILDING INITIATIVES

- Training of the NAQMH's staff
- Quality-of-care workshops for hospitals' personnel
- Facilitating best practices and knowledge exchanges between NAQMH and other countries' similar institutions (Greece, Kazakhstan, Portugal, etc.)
- Organizing events aiming to promote the quality-of-care and patient safety culture

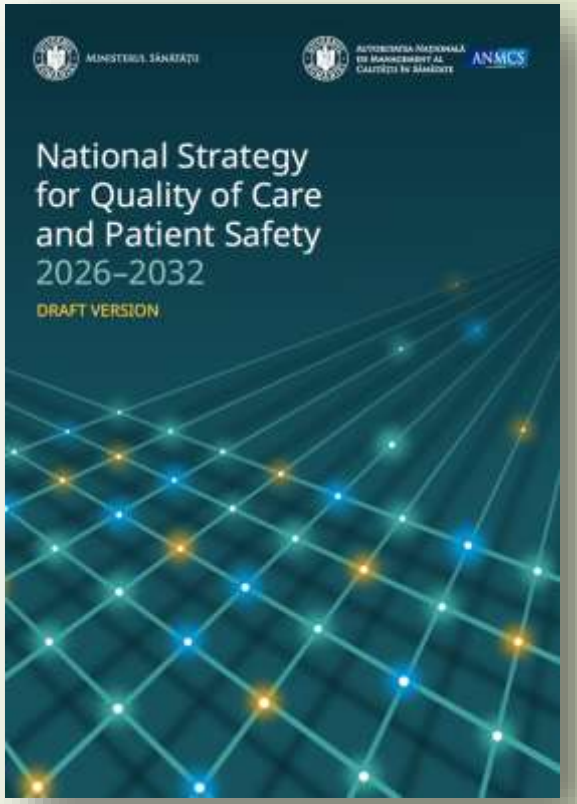
C. NATIONAL STRATEGY FOR QUALITY-OF-CARE AND PATIENT SAFETY (2026–2032)

- **VISION**

A continuously improving health system, where every person benefits from safe and high-quality care.

- **MISSION**

To guide all actors in the health system towards a transparent and evidence-based decision-making process, collaboration and participation, ensuring that health services deliver outcomes that matter to people.



NATIONAL STRATEGY FOR QoC



NATIONAL STRATEGY FOR QoC

THREE MAIN STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

***Improving the quality of care and patient safety governance at all levels of care* through:**

Strengthening leadership, accountability

Digital infrastructure

Data-based decision-making, Benchmarking and financing for quality.

***Reducing mortality, avoidable hospital admissions and health inequalities* through:**

- Standardizing clinical practice
- Addressing high-impact diseases
- Strengthening primary health care
- Reducing healthcare-associated infections, antimicrobial resistance and other patient safety incidents
- Improving equity of access.

- ***Promoting trust in the health system* through:**
- Increasing patient engagement
- Improving health literacy
- Improving patient experience,
- Transparency and partnership

NATIONAL STRATEGY FOR QUALITY-OF-CARE AND PATIENT SAFETY (2026–2032)

- The strategy includes **14 evaluation indicators**
- The **evaluation is linked to international comparators to track convergence with European standards.** The strategy focuses on a results-oriented system, using data from national dashboards, annual reporting cycles, patient-reported measures and safety culture assessments.
- **Developed in collaboration with national stakeholders and in consultation with the ANMCS Board of Directors, and aligned with WHO and OECD recommendations**, the Strategy sets a clear trajectory towards a safer, more efficient and more reliable healthcare system by 2032.

WHY ROMANIAN HOSPITALS NEED TO IMPLEMENT QoC CULTURE

- **Stronger Hospital Reputation and Public Trust -** Hospitals known for quality and safety often experience improved patient satisfaction and stronger community support.
- **Improved Workforce Engagement and Professional Development -** A quality-focused culture encourages staff participation in improvement activities
- **Data-Driven Quality Improvement**
- **Better Patient-Centered Care -** Modern quality strategies emphasize patient involvement and experience and patients' feedback becomes a valuable management tool for service improvement
- **Stronger Risk Management -** This shifts organizational culture from blame toward learning and prevention.
- **Support for Accreditation and Quality Certification**
- **Enhanced Compliance with National and European Standards -** Hospitals that adopt standardized quality systems are better positioned to meet future healthcare reforms and funding requirements.

WHY WE NEED **TO IMPLEMENT QoC CULTURE IN HOSPITALS**

- **Improved Patient Safety and Clinical Outcomes**
- **Better Organizational Performance -** Quality indicators provide objective data on hospital performance.
- **Increased Accountability and Transparency -** National quality indicators create a common framework for measuring performance across hospitals and transparent quality reporting strengthens trust among patients, healthcare professionals, and authorities.
- **Improved Financial Sustainability –** Quality improvement frequently leads to measurable cost avoidance and improved resource allocation.
- **Hospitals can address the issue of the low – value care -** John *et al.* (2026) identify a fundamental misalignment between delivered health services and quality and patient outcomes. The implication is the need for a reorientated health system focused on quality and patient-centered care

CONCLUSIONS (1) – BENEFITS OF QoC FOR HOSPITALS' MANAGEMENT

STRATEGIC AREA	MANAGEMENT ADVANTAGE
Governance	Stronger oversight and accountability
Finance	Lower costs from adverse events and inefficiencies
Operations	Improved efficiency and process standardization
Human Resources	Greater staff engagement and retention
Reputation	Increased patient trust and public confidence
Compliance	Better alignment with national and EU requirements
Risk Management	Reduced legal and safety risks
Performance	Data-driven continuous improvement

CONCLUSIONS (2)- LESSONS LEARNED

- The medical system is reluctant in shifting its focus toward quality and patient safety culture;
- Lack of motivation of healthcare personnel in implementing quality management standards;
- Quality monitoring in primary care and ambulatory care outside hospital settings poses an even bigger challenge than the hospital sector because of the fragmented nature of this care setting;
- Healthcare authorities, such as the NAQMH, MoH should aim to develop a patient safety culture for all types of care;

CONCLUSIONS (3) - KEY-CHALLENGES

- Raise awareness among health workforce, patients and public institutions regarding the need for quality of care and patient empowerment
- Identify financial resources needed for improving QoC and PE (Quality Fund)
- Build incentive programs for quality-of-care enhancement
- Work together for better QoC - Improving the quality of health services cannot be the project of a single institution but must be the project of all actors in the health system
- Raise the level of health literacy for general population

PATIENTS' SAFETY AND WELL-BEING THROUGH QUALITY OF CARE

THANK YOU!

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